

to the Google SketchUp Online Help Centre. The Learning Centre dialog mentioned earlier can be opened from here. Other options include Licensing, links to the Google SketchUp community, Updating facilities, a Bouquets and Brickbats facility for those possessing strong opinions and links where one can have access to online tutorials on specific subjects. More Plug-ins can be downloaded from the Google SketchUp website via an option in the submenu. One of the most useful tools present here is the Quick Reference Guide. On opening, a PDF file opens which contains a single page description (with options) on the most frequently used tools and options in Google SketchUp. This provides an excellent start-up for people already familiar with 3D modelling.

1.2.2 The Dialogs

The Dialog Boxes can be accessed from the Window submenu. These include:

1. **The Materials Dialog:** The Materials Dialog box allows you to choose the texture, colour and other aesthetics of your model. It is synonymous with the dialog that opens on selecting the Paint Bucket option under the Tools submenu.
2. **The Components Dialog:** The Components dialog allows easy control and manipulation of the various parts of your structure you have organised into components. It also allows the importing of predefined component templates.
3. **The Styles Dialog:** The styles dialog is your key to presenting your model well. It allows for fine surface details, textures, background images etc. It also allows the modification of the aspects of your model such as transparency (among others)
4. **The Layers Dialog:** All 2D and 3D modelling tools today incorporate the notion of layers. The concept of layers is based on the fact that we may often want to edit one aspect of our drawing without causing changes to the other. This is done by drawing individual portions in different layers. Google SketchUp incorporates this facility and allows easy editing. Through the layers dialog, you can create new layers and organize your drawing and its various components among the layers.
5. **The Outliner Dialog:** The Outliner dialog allows the user to provide outlines to the various structures in his drawing.